

Employee Travel and Expense Policy

Controlled Enterprise RAG Benchmark v1. Text-based single-column source document.

1. Purpose and Scope

This Employee Travel and Expense Policy defines how Meridian Retail Group employees request business travel, book transportation, select lodging, claim meals, and submit reimbursable expenses. The policy applies to all full-time employees, part-time employees, contractors with written travel authorization, and interns traveling on company business.

The policy covers domestic travel inside India and international travel outside India. It does not cover relocation benefits, client-funded event budgets, or personal vacation expenses attached to a business trip.

2. Travel Approval Rules

All travel must be requested in the Meridian Travel Portal before booking. Domestic trips require manager approval when the estimated trip cost is INR 20,000 or below and director approval above INR 20,000. International trips always require director approval, and trips above INR 250,000 require an additional finance controller review.

Requests must include business purpose, destination, expected travel dates, customer or project name, estimated airfare, hotel estimate, and expected daily meal allowance. Emergency travel may be approved after departure only when the traveler documents the operational incident or customer escalation.

Trip Type	Cost Threshold	Required Approval	Advance Notice
Domestic	Up to INR 20,000	Manager	3 business days
Domestic	Above INR 20,000	Director	5 business days
International	Up to INR 250,000	Director	10 business days
International	Above INR 250,000	Director + Finance Controller	15 business days

3. Domestic Travel Policy

Employees must select economy class for domestic flights under five hours. Premium economy is permitted for domestic routes of five hours or more when the fare difference is less than INR 4,000. Business class is limited to vice presidents and above, or to medical accommodation approved by Human Resources.

Rail travel may be booked in AC Chair Car, AC 2-tier, or Executive Chair Car when it is more practical than air travel. Personal vehicle reimbursement is allowed only for trips below 300 kilometers and is paid at INR 14 per kilometer.

4. International Travel Policy

International flights under six hours must be booked in economy class. Business class may be booked for international flight segments of six hours or more by employees at grade M4 and above. Employees below grade M4 need vice president approval for business class.

Business visas, mandatory vaccinations, and destination entry fees are reimbursable when supported by receipts. Passport renewal, personal travel insurance upgrades, and tourist visa extensions are not reimbursable.

5. Hotel Limits

Employees should book hotels through the Meridian Travel Portal unless a client-designated hotel is required. Hotel rates include room charge and taxes but exclude laundry, minibar, movies, and personal services.

Location Category	Employee Grade	Nightly Limit	Currency
India Tier 1 cities	E1-E5	INR 8,500	INR
India Tier 1 cities	M1 and above	INR 12,000	INR
India Tier 2 or Tier 3 cities	All grades	INR 6,500	INR
Standard international cities	E1-E5	USD 180	USD
Standard international cities	M1 and above	USD 260	USD
High-cost cities	All grades	Standard limit plus 35 percent	USD

6. Meal and Per-Diem Limits

Meal reimbursement is based on actual expenses up to the published cap. Alcohol is not reimbursable unless part of a client entertainment event approved by a director. When breakfast is included in the hotel rate, the breakfast allowance may not be claimed separately.

Meal Category	Domestic Cap	International Cap	Receipt Required
Breakfast	INR 350	USD 12	Above INR 250 or USD 10
Lunch	INR 600	USD 22	Above INR 500 or USD 15
Dinner	INR 900	USD 35	Above INR 500 or USD 15
Daily total	INR 1,850	USD 75	Always for international
Client entertainment	INR 7,500 per event	USD 150 per attendee	Always

7. Transportation Rules

Airport transfers, taxis, rideshare, metro fares, and parking are reimbursable when directly connected to approved business travel. Travelers must use standard rideshare categories unless safety, accessibility, or client schedule requirements justify a higher category.

Rental cars require manager approval before booking. Fuel and tolls for rental cars are reimbursable with receipts. Traffic fines, personal detours, and optional vehicle upgrades are not reimbursable.

8. Expense Submission and Reimbursement

Expense reports must be submitted in the Meridian Expense Portal within 30 calendar days after trip completion. Claims submitted between 31 and 60 days require manager approval and a late-submission reason. Claims submitted after 60 days are rejected unless a vice president approves an exception.

Approved reimbursements are paid in the next payroll cycle. Finance normally completes review within 7 business days when receipts, approvals, and cost center details are complete.

9. Exceptions

Policy exceptions must be requested before booking whenever possible. The request must include the policy limit, actual expected cost, business reason, and approving leader. Finance may audit any exception after reimbursement.

Repeated non-compliant booking outside the Travel Portal may result in loss of self-service travel privileges for 90 days.